

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Consolidation before durable expansion

1555 RESTORATION -> Mughal foothold, not a settled empire

1556 CRISIS -> Hemu, Sikandar Sur, Afghan strength and Kabul uncertainty

REGENCY -> Bairam Khan stabilises command during Akbar's minority

PERSONAL RULE -> household and noble alternatives are disciplined

EXPANSION -> campaigns are joined to alliances, ranks, jagirs and retention

VERDICT: durability came from reconquest + elite integration + institutions.

MUST REMEMBER: After Panipat II (1556), Akbar consolidated through campaigns, diplomacy, elite incorporation and negotiated alliances.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Akbar chronology 1542-1605

1542 Amarkot -> 1556 Kalanaur and Second Panipat
1556-60 -> Bairam Khan regency | 1562 -> Adham Khan crisis
1567 -> Uzbek challenge broken | 1568 -> Chittor
1572-73 -> Gujarat conquest and rapid return
1576 -> Daud Khan defeated; Haldighati
1580-81 -> eastern rebellion and Mirza Hakim | 1605 -> Akbar dies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The fractured field of 1556

HUMAYUN DIES -> young Akbar at Kalanaur + Bairam regency

SUR FIELD -> Adil Shah/Hemu + Sikandar Sur + Afghan networks

HEMU -> captures Agra/Delhi with largely Afghan political-military base

PANIPAT II -> captured guns + cavalry/elephants + command + arrow contingency

OUTCOME -> Delhi-Agra recovered, not all Afghan/frontier resistance ended

SOURCE -> numbers/execution differ across imperial and hostile narratives

VERDICT: restoration required years of consolidation after battlefield success.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Bairam Khan to personal rule

1556-60 -> wakil/regency stabilizes army, nobles and restored centre
TENSION -> appointments + faction + access + Akbar's maturing sovereignty
DISMISSAL -> authority struggle; Shia identity alone is inadequate
REBELLION/PARDON -> coercion and incorporation remain separate choices
HOUSEHOLD -> Maham Anaga/Adham/Atka = patronage networks, not gossip
1562 ADHAM CRISIS -> emperor becomes terminal arbiter
RULE: personal rule reorganized faction; it did not abolish faction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Noble and Uzbek challenge

UZBEK/TURANI NOBLES -> jagir + command + regional base + status

KHAN-I-ZAMAN -> armed challenge to central redistribution/supervision

MIRZAS -> Timurid genealogy and western networks

TOOLS -> campaign + pardon + transfer + confiscation + promotion

1567 -> major Uzbek resistance broken; expansion space widens

LIMIT -> nobles remain essential military/provincial partners

VERDICT: centralization was negotiated coercion, not instant absolutism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Malwa and Garh-Katanga: coercive limits

MALWA -> Baz Bahadur defeated; Adham corrected; Baz later enters Mughal service

GARH-KATANGA -> Rani Durgavati resists; conquest brings death and plunder

IMPERIAL VIEW -> expansion and agent discipline | REGIONAL VIEW -> agency and resources

TRAP: integration joined selective accommodation to severe coercion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Rajput policy in phases

AMBER 1562 -> Bhara Mal alliance; marriage is one mechanism

SERVICE -> Bhagwant Das/Man Singh + mansab/governorship/outside jagir

WATAN -> local rooted interest retained within imperial service

RANTHAMBHOR/SURJAN HADA -> service without universal marriage

CHITTOR 1568 -> siege/massacre + routes/symbolic sovereignty

MEWAR -> Udai Singh/Pratap reject submission and continue resistance

RULE: alliance + honour + rank + force; no homogeneous Rajput response.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Chittor, Ranthambhor and the Mewar exception

RAJASTHAN -> flank security and routes toward Malwa and Gujarat

CHITTOR -> strategic fort, symbolic resistance and massacre | RANTHAMBHOR -> settlement

MOST RAJAS -> honour, office and local status | MEWAR -> submission remains unresolved

RULE: force backed settlement; settlement did not erase refusal or violence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Gujarat and Bengal: conquest plus retention

GUJARAT 1572-73 -> ports/revenue + conquest + rapid return against revolt

CONTROL -> appointments/routes/garrisons convert victory into retention

BIHAR-BENGAL 1574-76 -> Tukaroi/Rajmahal + Daud Karrani defeat

RIVERS -> boats + monsoon + local chiefs/zamindars + recurring Afghan networks

ODISHA -> eastern extension remained uneven

COMPARE HUMAYUN -> victory alone failed; Akbar built repeated follow-up

CAUTION: neither region became permanently quiet in one campaign.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Haldighati: coalition and outcome

1576 MUGHAL -> Man Singh leads mixed imperial service army

MEWAR -> Pratap + Rajput retainers + Bhils + Hakim Khan Sur Afghans

BATTLE -> Mughal field advantage; no capture/death of Pratap

AFTERMATH -> Chavand + guerrilla/terrain resistance + partial recovery

MEMORY -> heroic/communal/national narratives require source comparison

LATER SETTLEMENT -> Amar Singh/Jahangir, outside Akbar's reign

VERDICT: battle did not end Mewar autonomy/resistance.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rajput policy was differentiated across houses and moments; alliance, service, resistance and coercion coexisted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Rebellion, frontier and source method

1580-81 -> eastern rebellion + Mirza Hakim/Kabul pressure

LAHORE 1585-98 -> mobile court supervises north-west

ROSHANAI/PASHTUN FIELD -> religion + society + frontier politics

KASHMIR 1586 | SINDH 1591 | QANDAHAR 1595 -> different control methods

DECCAN -> Chand Bibi/Berar/Ahmadnagar + Khandesh/Asirgarh, unstable

SOURCE -> Akbarnama teleology + Badauni hostility + regional/material checks

RULE: frontier is an uneven process, not a coloured boundary line.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Expansion maps indicate changing claims and fronts, not uniform administration over every shaded territory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 15 answer spine

SOURCE -> imperial/hostile/regional/admin/material comparison

1556-67 -> Panipat + regency + household/noble consolidation

MAP -> region/date + conquest/annexation/alliance/tribute/frontier outcome

ELITES -> Rajput/Afghan/Mughal diversity + rank/watan/jagir + coercion

MOBILITY -> Agra/Fatehpur/Lahore/camp + roads/forts/logistics

BOUNDARY -> Topic 16 administration + Topic 17 religion + Topic 18 Deccan

VERDICT -> durable but uneven empire; imperial integration, not nation-building.